Chapter 2 — Competitor analysis (India and global)

Research date: November 2026. Public-company numbers come from company releases and filings as reported in the press; links are listed per row. Private-company numbers are **third-party estimates** and are marked as such. Currency is shown in the company's reporting currency to avoid conversion errors.

2.1 How the industry is structured

Roadside assistance worldwide is sold in three ways, and they have very different economics:

1. **Membership clubs** (AA and RAC in the UK, ADAC in Germany, AAA in the US). Customers pay an annual subscription. Revenue is recurring and prepaid, so the club can afford its own patrol fleet. **Highly profitable.**
2. **B2B2C assistance providers** (Agero, Allianz Partners, Europ Assistance, TVS Auto Assist, Urgently). Insurers and car makers pay per vehicle or per job. The provider runs a control room and **subcontracts the physical work to local tow operators**. Margins are thin, and the business depends on a few big contracts.
3. **Lead marketplaces and local operators** (Justdial, Google listings, thousands of independent towers). Highly fragmented. The information layer (Justdial) is very profitable; the towers themselves are small cash businesses.

RoadSaathi starts as a consumer marketplace (model 3, done properly), sells its supply network into model 2, and adds memberships (model 1) once the service is trusted.

2.2 Global players

Company	Model	Latest reported revenue	EBITDA / profit	Why profit or loss
The AA (UK, private equity-owned)	Membership + insurance broking; own patrol fleet; 3.5 m breakdowns attended in 2025	**£1.5 bn** revenue (FY to Jan 2025, +12 %)	**Adj. EBITDA £450 m (≈ 30 %)**; operating profit £245 m	Recurring prepaid memberships, dense patrol network, cross-sell of insurance. Carries large private-equity debt. City AM, AA investors
RAC (UK, private equity-owned)	Membership; ~16 m members; breakdown, insurance, servicing	**£840 m** (FY2025, +7 %); H1 2026 £436 m	**EBITDA £329 m (39.2 % margin)**	Subscription pricing power and scale density. Breakdown is the core (£367 m of H1 2026 revenue). RAC FY2025 investor report, RAC H1 2026
Urgently (US, was Nasdaq: ULY)	Digital roadside platform for OEMs and insurers; asset-light, subcontracted providers	**US$129.2 m** (FY2025, −10 %)	**Net loss US$20.4 m**; operating loss US$8.9 m (improved from US$27.2 m). Reported margin ≈ 26 % in Q4 2025	Asset-light middleman with thin margins, contract losses and customer concentration, plus heavy debt. **Agreed to be acquired by Agero at US$5.50/share** (2026). Stockanalysis, SEC 8-K, Coverager

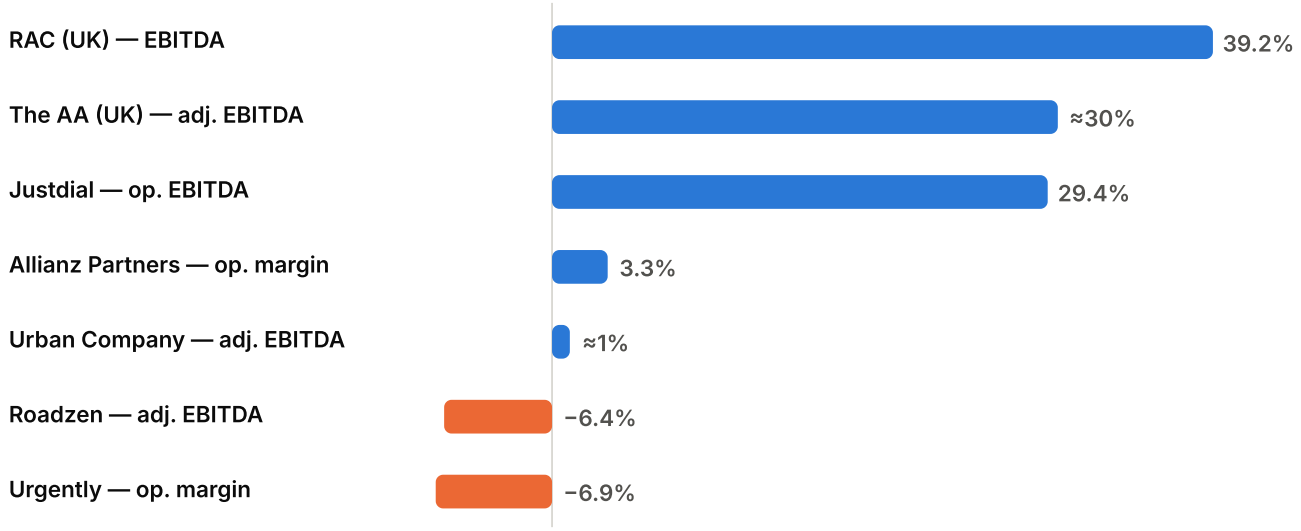
Company	Model	Latest reported revenue	EBITDA / profit	Why profit or loss
Agero (US, private)	B2B2C roadside and claims for insurers/OEMs; now owns Urgently	Not published; third-party estimates around **US$0.5–0.6 bn**	Not published	Scale player consolidating the US market. Buying Urgently shows that sub-scale digital players struggle alone. Lightsource profile (estimate)
HONK (US, private)	On-demand roadside marketplace + B2B partner programs	Estimates range **US$18–35 m** (unreliable)	Not published	~US$32–33 m raised in total. Shows consumer-plus-B2B marketplaces can survive but stay small without memberships. Tracxn
Allianz Partners (global assistance)	Travel insurance + assistance + roadside for OEMs/insurers; 36.9 m roadside cases in 2024	**€10.1 bn** total (2024, all lines)	**Operating profit €333.5 m (≈ 3.3 %)**	Huge volume but thin margins, because assistance is a low-margin service bundled for B2B clients. Allianz Partners 2024

2.3 Indian players

Company	Model	Revenue	Profit / EBITDA	Notes
Roadzen (Nasdaq: RDZN; large India operation)	Insurtech + roadside assistance + claims technology for insurers, OEMs and dealers	**US$55.0 m** (FY ending Mar 2026, +24 %); Q1 FY27 US$16.2 m (+49 %)	**Net loss US$22.5 m**; **adj. EBITDA loss US$3.5 m**; gross margin 61.3 %	Losses narrowing fast as one-off listing and integration costs fall away. The closest listed "Indian roadside tech" comparable. Roadzen FY2026 release, TradingView
ReadyAssist (Bengaluru, private)	RSA for OEMs/fleets/insurers + retail app	**₹12.8 cr+** (FY25, Inc42); Tracxn band ₹10–50 cr	Not reliably published	~US$6–7 m raised (pre-Series A of US$5 m). Our most direct Indian startup comparable. Inc42, Tracxn
TVS Auto Assist (Chennai; JV of TVS Automobile Solutions and the AA, UK)	B2B RSA for OEMs/insurers; 4,000+ authorised service providers, 1,795 locations, 28 states	Segment revenue not published	Not published	Shows the subcontracting model: the network *is* local operators like our partners. A potential **customer** for our Delhi supply, not only a competitor. Motor India
Allianz Partners India, **Europ Assistance India**	B2B RSA bundled with insurance and OEM warranties	Europ Assistance India: revenue band ₹1–100 cr (FY2023, Tofler)	Not published	Same model as above. Potential fulfilment clients. Tofler
Justdial (NSE: JUSTDIAL)	Local search and lead marketplace; where most Delhi towing customers search today	**₹1,141.9 cr** operating revenue (FY25, +9.5 %)	**Operating EBITDA ₹335 cr (29.4 %)**; net profit ₹584 cr, helped by ₹386 cr other income	Sells *leads*, not fulfilment: no trucks, no liability, very high margin. Our product replaces the "call five strangers" experience that follows a Justdial search. Business Standard

Company	Model	Revenue	Profit / EBITDA	Notes
Urban Company (NSE-listed, 2025) — *model benchmark, not a competitor*	Managed marketplace for home services, standardised and trained partners	**₹1,144 cr** (FY25, +38 %)	Net profit ₹239.8 cr incl. ₹211 cr deferred tax credit; PBT ≈ ₹28.6 cr; adj. EBITDA ≈ ₹12 cr	Took about a decade to reach operating break-even. Proves Indian consumers pay for **standardised, trusted, priced-upfront** services. Medianama, Outlook Business
GoMechanic — *cautionary case*	Car-service aggregator	—	Collapsed January 2023: founders admitted "grave errors" in financial reporting, 70 % of staff laid off	Growth-at-all-costs plus weak financial controls. Lesson: audited books, a real-time ledger and governance from day one. Business Standard
Unorganised local towers (thousands in NCR)	Phone and cash; listed on Justdial and Google	Small cash businesses	—	Our **supply**, not just our competition. Most will earn more on the platform than off it (higher utilisation)

2.4 Margin comparison (latest reported year)



Blue = profit, orange = loss. Margins use each company's own reported measure (EBITDA, adjusted EBITDA or operating margin, as labelled), so they show the pattern rather than a strict like-for-like comparison. Sources are in the tables above.

2.5 What the numbers teach us

1. **Recurring revenue wins.** The two most profitable roadside businesses in the world (RAC 39 %, AA 30 %) earn annual memberships *before* any breakdown happens. → RoadSaathi adds an RSA membership in year 2 (chapter 7).
2. **Pure middlemen lose.** Urgently had a modern app and big OEM contracts but thin margins, customer concentration and debt. It shrank 10 % and was sold for about US$5.50 a share. → We must keep a real take rate, diversify clients, and avoid debt-funded growth.

3. **Information is cheap to sell, fulfilment is expensive.** Justdial earns 29 % EBITDA by selling leads; the towers do the hard work. → Our software (operator SaaS, white-label) should earn margin with no truck cost.
4. **Indian consumers pay for standardised trust.** Urban Company built a ₹1,144 cr business on upfront prices, trained partners and guarantees. It took about ten years, which shows how long patient capital takes. → Trip PIN, ratings, invoices and damage process are the product, not extras.
5. **Governance is existential.** GoMechanic's collapse came from accounting, not product. → Integer-paise ledger, immutable signed contracts, audit log (already built) plus audited books from year 1.
6. **B2B assistance companies are customers, not only rivals.** TVS Auto Assist, Allianz and Europ subcontract to local operators. A dense, tracked, verified Delhi network is something they would buy.

2.6 Our positioning statement

> For vehicle owners in Delhi-NCR who are stuck on the road, **RoadSaathi** is the towing and roadside service that shows the price before you book, tracks the truck live and only lets the verified driver start the job. Unlike calling numbers from a listing, every job comes with a trip PIN, a rating and a GST invoice. For insurers, dealers and fleets, RoadSaathi is a ready, tracked fulfilment network with an API.